

SAFEGUARDING POLICY

January, 2021



1. Introduction

Mudzini Cultural Centre is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all individuals who engage with our programs, services, and activities. We believe that every person, regardless of age, gender, disability, ethnic origin, religion, or socio-economic background, has the right to be protected from all forms of harm, abuse, neglect, and exploitation.

This policy outlines our approach to creating a safe environment and ensuring prompt action when safeguarding concerns arise. It applies to all staff, volunteers, board members, contractors, and partners.

2. Purpose of the Policy

The purpose of this Safeguarding Policy is to: Protect children, young people, and vulnerable adults from harm; Provide clear guidelines for identifying and responding to safeguarding concerns; Establish a culture of safety, transparency, and accountability; and comply with relevant Kenyan laws and international safeguarding standards.

3. Definitions

Child: Any person under the age of 18.

Vulnerable Adult: An adult who, due to age, disability, illness, or circumstances, is unable to protect themselves from harm or exploitation.

Safeguarding: The measures taken to protect people's health, well-being, and human rights, enabling them to live free from abuse, harm, and neglect.

Abuse: Includes physical, emotional, sexual, and financial abuse, as well as neglect and exploitation.

4. Policy Statement

We will: Prioritize safety and well-being; Ensure safeguarding training; Take immediate and appropriate action when concerns arise; Maintain confidentiality; and Partner only with organizations that share our safeguarding commitment.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Board of Directors: Approves the policy and oversees implementation.

Safeguarding Officer: Leads safeguarding efforts, receives reports, and ensures follow-

up.

All Staff & Volunteers: Follow procedures, report concerns, and maintain professional boundaries.

6. Safeguarding Measures

Recruitment and Training: Conduct background checks; Include safeguarding in contracts; Provide mandatory training.

Code of Conduct: Treat everyone with respect; Avoid being alone with a child or vulnerable adult unless necessary; Never engage in sexual or exploitative relationships; Use respectful language.

7. Recognizing and Responding to Concerns

Signs of abuse may include unexplained injuries, withdrawal, fearfulness, sudden changes in behavior, or inappropriate sexual knowledge.

Reporting Procedure: Report immediately to the Safeguarding Officer; Document factually; Officer will assess and, if necessary, report to authorities.

8. Confidentiality and Record Keeping

All records must be kept secure and confidential. Information will be shared only with individuals or agencies directly involved in safeguarding action.

9. Partnerships and Third Parties

We will collaborate only with partners committed to safeguarding, conducting due diligence to ensure standards are met.

10. Monitoring and Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or after any safeguarding incident. Lessons learned will inform updates.

11. Non-Compliance

Any breach of this policy will result in disciplinary action, which may include termination or legal action.

Approval

Approved by: Mudzini Cultural Centre

Date: 8/1/2021